

Why Board Development

What your organization gains when your board becomes a fundraising board.

— The Outcomes We Deliver

A Board That Gives

Every member makes a meaningful gift, so the board reaches 100% participation before the first outside ask.

A Board That Opens Doors

New members are recruited for capacity, networks, and passion for the mission, not just to fill seats.

Clear Expectations

Signed responsibilities, a written give/get policy, and an annual scorecard keep everyone accountable.

A Confident Ask

Members are trained and coached so they are ready to cultivate and solicit alongside your staff.

The Catapult Advantage

Board development built for fundraising, not paperwork.

Catapult helps boards move from governance and policy to philanthropy: recruiting the right people, setting clear expectations, and preparing every member to give, open doors, and make the ask.

— Why Organizations Choose Catapult

Research Before Recruitment

Every prospect is profiled for wealth capacity, interest, and fit before an invitation goes out.

Tied to Your Fundraising

Board work connects directly to your campaign, major gifts, and signature events.

Senior-Led Conversations

Catapult leadership meets prospective members alongside your CEO or board chair.

Deliberate, Not Rushed

Members are added thoughtfully, so each one fits your values and works well with the team.

Board Development Methodology

A research-led process that builds the board before it builds the campaign.

Every engagement starts with a clear picture of your current board and a written plan for who you need, how many, and by when.

— How the Engagement Is Built

3-Year

Board recruitment plan with seats, skills, and timeline

18 Months

Typical first engagement to launch the plan

30+

Research sources behind each prospect profile

100%

Board giving secured before outside solicitation

Give / Get

Written policy: a personal gift or funds raised

1 Committee

First step for new members before a board vote

Annual

Scorecard review between each member and the chair

Bi-Weekly

Team meetings throughout the engagement

The Board Development Journey

Five connected steps, from first assessment to a board that raises money.

From Assessment to Activation

1

Assess

Review bylaws, roster, board giving, terms, and the skills your board is missing.

2

Define

Write responsibilities, expectations, give/get policy, and a committee structure.

3

Recruit

Identify and profile prospects, invite with a case summary, and interview.

4

Orient

Welcome new members with an orientation program and board binder.

5

Activate

Solicitation training, give/get tracking, scorecards, and an annual retreat.

What We Look For in a New Board Member

Passion for the Mission

Personal Giving Capacity

A Network That Gives

Skills the Board Needs

Board Development in Action

Recent work building and strengthening boards.

Selected Results

NEW FOUNDATION BOARD

10

Founding members recruited

For a Nevada healthcare nonprofit launching its foundation, Catapult drafted bylaws, officer roles, and give/get commitments and researched 101 board prospect profiles.

THE SALVATION ARMY SOUTHERN NEVADA

\$2,500 / \$5,000

Give or get, per member each year

Catapult rebuilt the advisory board around a signed give/get policy, working committees, and a recruitment process, then expanded the work to a second corps.

STATEWIDE YOUTH NONPROFIT

19

Prospects open to leadership roles

A donor assessment also found 28 people willing to make introductions, giving the board a recruiting pipeline instead of a list of open seats.

“Thank you for the outstanding presentation you delivered to our board today! It certainly raised the level of awareness and engagement from these wonderful folks. You guys are an all star team!”

Rene Cantu, Ph.D.
Executive Director, Jobs for
Nevada’s Graduates

Program Benefits

Everything your board needs to recruit, give, and ask with confidence.

— What's Included



Bylaws & Policy Review

Terms of service, committee descriptions, conflict of interest, and gift acceptance policies.



Responsibilities & Give/Get

A signed expectations agreement and a written give/get policy for every member.



Prospect Research Included

Confidential research profiles on every board prospect at no additional cost.



Recruitment Kit & Case Summary

Invitation letters and a case summary that give prospects a reason to say yes.



Orientation Program

A welcome process and board binder so new members contribute from day one.



Solicitation Training

Making the Ask training plus a short ask tip at every board meeting.